- Makes it delicious and appetizing to eat.
- Makes it more tender.
- Makes it easier to digest.
- Makes it safe to eat - kill any harmful bacteria it may have picked up during handling.

### 4.1.6 Changes that occur during cooking:

- On cooking, the red pigment of meat turns brown due to the denaturation of protein pigment.
- Cooking (heat treatment) also brings about inactivation of enzymes and denaturation of proteins, which makes the meat tougher
- When meat is cooked volatile compounds from both fat and lean meat are released which contributes to the flavour and taste of cooked meat.
- Cooking melts the meat fat which increases palatability of meat when eaten hot.
- There is loss of water on cooking meat which does not change the nutritive value but may affect the juiciness and brings about shrinkage in volume and weight.

## 4.2 Poultry

The term poultry is applied to all domesticated birds used as food and includes chicken, ducks, geese, turkeys and pigeons. Of these, chicken and turkey are most commonly used for their meat.



**Fig 4.5:** Broiler chicken

### 4.2.1Classification

Poultry is classified based on age. Age influences tenderness and fat content of the poultry. According to Indian standards, the classification is as follows:

**Broiler or fryer:** Chicken of 8 to 10 weeks of age either sex, having tender meat with soft, pliable smooth textured skin and flexible breastbone cartilage.

**Roaster:** A young chicken, usually 3 to 5 months of age, of either sex, having tender meat with soft, pliable smooth textured skin and breastbone cartilage that may be somewhat less flexible that of the broiler or fryer.

**Stag:** A male chicken, usually under 10 months of age with coarse skin, somewhat toughened and darkened flesh and a considerable hardening of the breastbone cartilage.

**Stewing chicken or fowl:** A mature chicken, usually more than 10 months of age, with meat less tender than that of a roaster and inflexible breastbone tip.

**Cock:** A mature male chicken, usually over 10 months of age, with coarse skin, toughened and darkened meat and hardened breastbone tip.



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